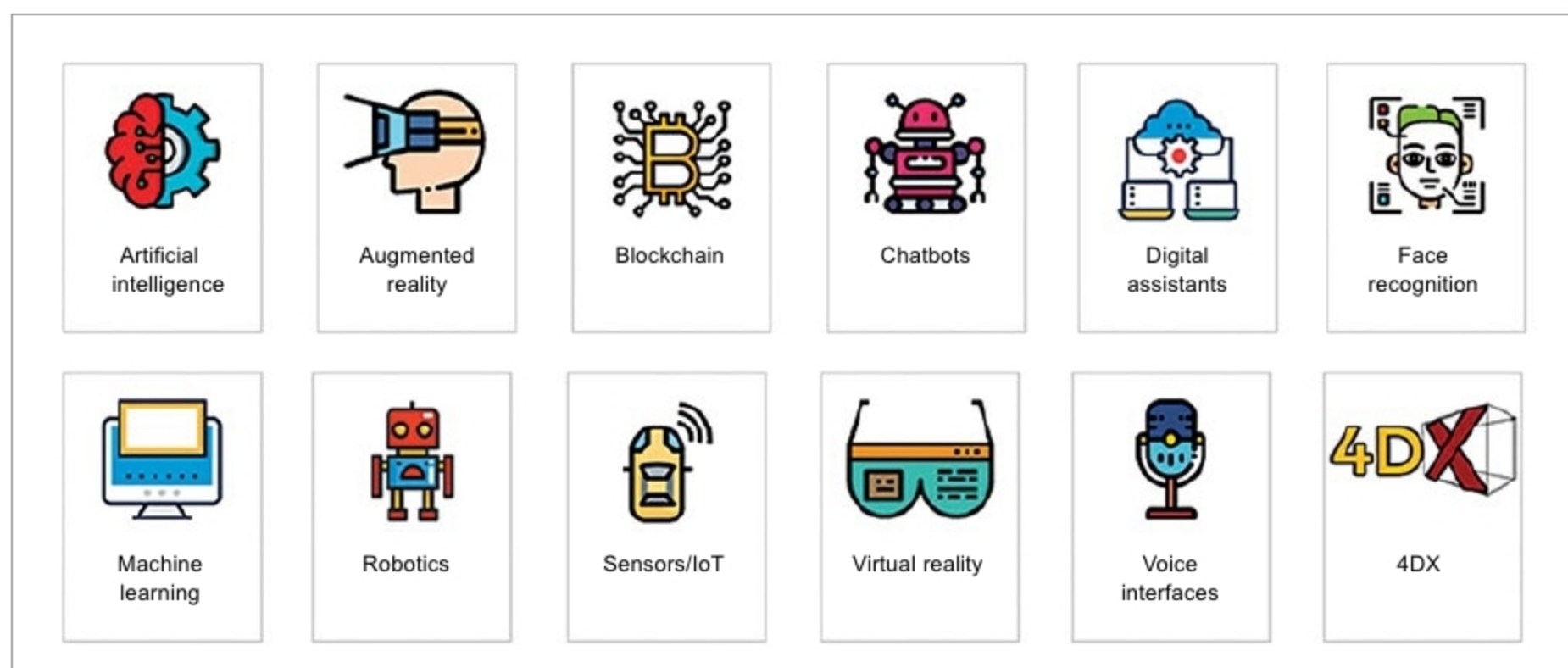




Emerging technologies transforming the entertainment and media industry (Credit: www.hiddenbrains.com)

for a larger number of international language content versions being generated than ever before. AI can be embraced wisely to reduce cost and achieve faster time-to-market for a large volume of content. It will be increasingly used to review existing media libraries to enable faster content discovery and create new sources of revenue.

Behaviour of non-player characters in video games is one well-known example of AI algorithms at work. AI tools and technologies such as facial, speech and object recognition are also changing the way players participate in games, from *avatars* that reproduce a player's movements on the screen to fully immersive AR environments.

To win on the content and distribution front, **media companies are using various technologies and concepts such as Big Data, AI and blockchain, aiming to predict and create content that consumers want, personalise it as per their preferences, optimise streaming to provide a seamless user experience and also manage transactions in a transparent manner.**

Players are primarily adopting one of the three models: paid access to premium content with the rest of it free, subscription-based and advertisement-driven.

Role of hardware technology

Quality and rendering require increased computing capabilities and

significantly increase demand for data storage, processing and analysis capacity. Technological advances have completely changed consumer expectations. These have also enabled content developers to bring their wildest and most innovative ideas to the screen. Dolby sound systems, high-resolution motion cameras and high-end rendering software have revolutionised 3D and 4D cinema experiences.

High-resolution displays have enhanced the viewing experience. Customers now want customised products (namely, playback options, colour, control options, etc) as per their requirement.

LED and OLED technologies have improved the quality and lifespan of screens. Screens have shrunk from auditorium-sized movie screens to living-room TV screens, PCs, laptops, tablets and, finally, phones and watches. The phone is the ultimate personal screen. It generates a ton of data that is analysed and put to use by customers.

Increase in bandwidth in network infrastructures requires all associated components within a network to be compatible. Henceforth, demand on the switch, which distributes all packets accordingly, is increasing enormously. Media technology services demand a guaranteed and therefore reserved bandwidth. Routing components must guarantee this on all ports and their internal backbone in the

media entertainment industry. Media technology is increasingly becoming a discipline for the IT world, as it requires basic understanding of AV equipment.

Moving forward

Technological evolution has supported greater digital ad consumption and personalisation from desktops and iPads to mobile and voice-based assistants, with AI, AR and VR likely to follow. **Advertising on social media, especially using video, has become one of the fastest drivers of growth, because small and medium businesses have been increasingly using these formats.**

Other hot spots for media growth include e-books, digital music, broadcast and satellite TV, and video games that can be PC- or app-based, and so on.

With consumers increasingly becoming multi-device, multi-platform users, brands must know exactly where their target audience spends their time and why. New channels and devices are becoming central to the entertainment habits of consumers, but traditional channels like broadcast TVs still play a crucial role in an effective end-to-end marketing strategy.

Social media services are also investing in long-form video platforms and looking more at music licensing, ultimately to upgrade social media to a one-stop entertainment hub for users. **EFY**